

Modify Cloud Compute Infrastructure

Sub-techniques (5) 

An adversary may attempt to modify a cloud account's compute service infrastructure to evade defenses. A modification to the compute service infrastructure can include the creation, deletion, or modification of one or more components such as compute instances, virtual machines, and snapshots.

Permissions gained from the modification of infrastructure components may bypass restrictions that prevent access to existing infrastructure. Modifying infrastructure components may also allow an adversary to evade detection and remove evidence of their presence.^[1]

ID: T1578

Sub-techniques: [T1578.001](#), [T1578.002](#), [T1578.003](#), [T1578.004](#), [T1578.005](#)

 **Tactic:** [Defense Impairment](#)

 **Platforms:** IaaS

Version: 2.0

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[Version Permalink](#)

Mitigations

ID	Mitigation	Description
M1047	Audit	Routinely monitor user permissions to ensure only the expected users have the capability to modify cloud compute infrastructure components.
M1018	User Account Management	Limit permissions for creating, deleting, and otherwise altering compute components in accordance with least privilege. Organizations should limit the number of users within the organization with an IAM role that has administrative privileges, strive to reduce all permanent privileged role assignments, and conduct periodic entitlement reviews on IAM users, roles and policies. ^[1]

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0308	Detection Strategy for Modify Cloud Compute Infrastructure	AN0861	Detection focuses on identifying unauthorized or anomalous changes to compute infrastructure components. Defender perspective: monitor for creation, deletion, or modification of instances, volumes, and snapshots outside of approved change management windows; correlate abnormal activity such as rapid snapshot creation followed by new instance mounts, or repeated infrastructure changes by rarely used accounts. Flagging activity linked to unusual geolocation, API client, or automation script is suspicious.

References

1. [Mandiant. \(2020, February\). M-Trends 2020. Retrieved November 17, 2024.](#)